Benjamin Parkhurst

+1 (650) 839-3514 · bdp2126@columbia.edu · linkedin.com/in/bdparkhurst

EDUCATION

Columbia University — New York, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Linguistics, Minor in Music. — *Sep 2022 - May 2026*

Butler University — Buenos Aires, Argentina
Institute for Study Abroad program, all coursework in Spanish. — *May - Jun 2023*

PUBLICATIONS

Parkhurst, B., L. Lloy, & S. V. Levi. [Under review]. (Up)talking by ourselves: Final rising intonation in the absence of interlocutors. *Proc. Mtgs. Acoust.* 12 May 2026; 61 (1): 015001.

Parkhurst, B. 2026. *An Acoustic Sketch of Kalmyk-Oirad.* Columbia University undergraduate thesis.

Parkhurst, B., E. Steele, & S. Bryden. 2024. Evaluating the Functional Head Constraint: Spanish-English Intra-DP Code-switching. In *Proceedings of the Fifth Emory Undergraduate Linguistics Conference.*

PRESENTATIONS

Parkhurst, B. [Accepted for presentation]. Acoustic evidence supports two distinct schwa vowels in Kalmyk. Talk. *Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting* (6-9 Jan. 2027), San Francisco, CA, United States.

Parkhurst, B. & P. M. Carter. [Accepted for presentation]. The Grammatical Development of English in Miami: Spanish-Origin Adverbial Calques and Minor Grammatical Phenomena. Talk. *American Dialect Society Annual Meeting* (6-9 Jan. 2027), San Francisco, CA, United States.

Parkhurst, B. & P. M. Carter. 2026. Perception and Production of Spanish-Origin Adverbial and Minor Grammatical Calques. Special session talk. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 54* (22-24 Oct. 2026), Montreal, QC, Canada.

Parkhurst, B., L. Lloy, & S. V. Levi. 2026. (Up)talking by ourselves: Final rising intonation in the absence of interlocutors. Poster. *Annual Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America* (11-15 May 2026), Philadelphia, PA, United States.

Parkhurst, B. & P. M. Carter. 2026. Spanish-Origin Adverbial and Minor Grammatical Calques in Miami English: Testing Production and Perception. Talk. *American Dialect Society Annual Meeting* (8-11 Jan. 2026), New Orleans, LA, United States.

Parkhurst, B., L. Lloy, & S. V. Levi. 2025. (Up)talking to ourselves: Final rising intonation in the absence of interlocutors. Poster. *Columbia Undergraduate Research Symposium* (23 Oct. 2025), New York, NY, United States.

Parkhurst, B. & P. M. Carter. 2024. Spanish-Origin Adverbial Calques in Miami English: Testing Production and Perception. Talk. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52* (7-9 Nov. 2024), Miami, FL, United States.

Parkhurst, B., E. Steele, & S. Bryden. 2024. Evaluating the Functional Head Constraint: Spanish-English Intra-DP Code-switching. Talk. *Fifth Emory Undergraduate Linguistics Conference* (19 Apr. 2024), Atlanta, GA, United States.

DIGITAL RESOURCES

Gedeeva, D., G. Dordzhieva, E. Okchaev, S. Bryden, A. Frey, M. Landman, J. J. Lim, **B. Parkhurst**, K. Rojas, S. Sabet, A. Schiffel-Golab, C. J. Schulz, K. Tran, J. Wu, & C. Zhang. 2026. *Kalmyk Living Dictionary*. Living Tongues Institute for Endangered Languages.

Parkhurst, B. 2026. xal-keyboard.

Landman, M., S. Bryden, J. Choi, P. Johnson, **B. Parkhurst**, J. Prado, J. Sanning, A. Thomas, & Y. Zheng. 2026. *Columbia Kalmyk Corpus*.

GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

- 2026. Magna Cum Laude. Columbia University.
- 2026. Departmental Honors in Linguistics. Columbia University.
- 2026. Phi Beta Kappa. Columbia University.
- 2026. Conference Travel Grant ($1,330). New York University.
- 2026. Conference Travel Grant ($261). Columbia University.
- 2025 - 2026. NSF Research Experiences for Undergraduates ($7,200). New York University.
- 2025. Rhodes Scholarship Endorsement. Columbia University.
- 2024. Kraft Global Fellow in Santiago, Chile. Columbia University.

- 2023. Core Scholars Honorable Mention. Columbia University.
- 2022 - 2026. Dean's List (all eight semesters). Columbia University.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Associate Research Scientist Jun 2025 - Present
Acoustic Phonetics and Perception Lab (APPL) at New York University *New York, NY*

- Process speech data using Whisper, Praat, and the Montreal Forced Aligner for PhD student paper on gender-diverse f0
- Write Python scripts and workflow documents to streamline data annotation pipeline for future research assistants
- Design and implement experiments for NSF-funded study on benefits of talker familiarity and exposure to L2 English speech
- Conduct original research in lab corpus (REFF-US dataset) on speaker intonation patterns in declarative utterances
- Recruit participants and gather electroglottographic data to investigate acoustic and articulatory properties of vocal fry

Legal Research Assistant May 2024 - Present
Carter Linguistics Research & Consulting LLC - Contract *Remote*

- Assist Phillip Carter, Ph.D, to compile expert witness reports for linguistic copyright and trademark law cases
- Research and write various report sections with data from English dictionaries, Davies Corpora, Google Trends, Google Ngram Viewer, product reviews, style manuals, academic papers, and specialized case-specific sources
- Perform linguistic and semiotic analysis of sight, sound, and meaning between marks for confusion cases
- Train new research assistants on current case work and create training materials simulating corpus use in cases

Jazz Musician Jun 2017 - Present
Freelance *New York and Los Angeles*

- Professional upright and electric bass player in small group, big band, and singer-songwriter settings
- Live performances at the Johnny Pacheco Latin Music and Jazz Festival (live on BronxNet), Columbia Bacchanal 2024 opening for JID and AG Club, Catalina Jazz Club, Industry Cafe, Symphony Space, Berlin, and Nublu Classic
- Participated in Louis Armstrong Jazz Performance Program ensembles at Columbia University, guest artist performances with Anat Cohen, Bob Mintzer, Ole Mathisen, and Nir Felder at the Lee C. Bollinger Forum
- Explain and demonstrate jazz for non-musician audiences for Columbia University's Music Humanities curriculum
- Studied with Kevin Axt, Katie Thrioux, Leo Traversa, Ugonna Okegwo, Vince Cherico, Don Sickler, and David Gibson
- Hired by Columbia University to play at holiday parties, welcome receptions, retirement ceremonies, and awards dinners

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

EFL Teacher Jun 2025 - Nov 2025
Teach English CU/HEU Learning *New York, NY*

- Instructed native Spanish-speaking adults with various educational and migratory backgrounds with co-teacher
- Developed resources for students to supplement textbook materials and foster learning outside of twice-weekly classes
- Trained new teachers on best practices for delivering and expanding on lesson material

Teaching Assistant (TA) Sep 2023 - May 2026
Columbia University Linguistics Department *New York, NY*

- TA for Professor John McWhorter's Intro to Linguistics in Fall 2023 and Fall 2025, Language and Society in Spring 2024 and Spring 2026, Professor William Foley's Intro to Linguistics in Fall 2024
- Presented in front of and supported over 240 students during weekly and by-appointment office hours and review sessions
- Graded 1000+ assignments and exams, developed rubrics with professors and TAs for consistent and equitable grading

SKILLS

Technical/Software: Python (`pandas`, `SciPy`, `scikit-learn`, `NLTK`, `spaCy`, `matplotlib`, `RapidFuzz`, `GeoPandas`), R (`tidyverse`, `lme4`, `emmeans`, `car`, `mgcv`, `itsadug`, `maxent.ot`, `praatpicture`), LaTeX, Git, Markdown, Pandoc, Office and Drive Suites, Qualtrics, Gorilla Experiment Builder, Prolific, Electroglottography, Praat & Praat scripting, FFmpeg, Whisper, Montreal Forced Aligner, Audacity, MuseScore, WordPress, Canva, Canvas, Davies Corpora
Languages: English (native), Spanish (fluent), Korean (intermediate), Italian & Portuguese (reading), Kalmyk (fieldwork)
Certifications: CITI RCR Social and Behavioral at Columbia, CITI Social & Behavioral Research at NYU, Distinguished Bartender Award & Bartending Certificate from Columbia School of Mixology/Columbia Bartending Association